SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

August 10, 2026 | 04:26 PM ET

MACRO REGIME: Risk-On (Large-Cap Leadership)

VIX 15.4 (-1.6 vs 20d) | SPY 20d +2.8% | IWM 20d +1.9% | IWM/SPY trend -0.9%

Leaders: Healthcare (+6.4%), Energy (+5.7%), Materials (+5.0%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (1)	B - Building (4)	C - Early Stage (7)
ACA	ORKA	HWC
	CLDX	WSBC
	ADPT	AUB
	AXGN	LGND
		INDB
		FBK
		FBNC

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
A	**ACA**	**Arcosa, Inc.**	**Infrastructure Spend**	**$7.11B**	**$144.73**	**$145.98**	**0.9%**	**+6.9**	**YES**	**no**
B	ORKA	Oruka Therapeutic	Next-Gen Biologics &	$6.34B	$105.14	$105.31	0.2%	+55.2	YES	YES
B	CLDX	Celldex Therapeut	Antibody Therapeutic	$3.37B	$42.97	$43.21	0.6%	+28.3	YES	YES
B	ADPT	Adaptive Biotechn	Precision Diagnostic	$4.05B	$25.45	$26.16	2.8%	+83.1	YES	YES
B	AXGN	AxoGen, Inc.	Surgical Nerve Repai	$2.59B	$48.22	$48.72	1.0%	+13.4	YES	YES
C	HWC	Hancock Whitney C	Regional Bank NIM Re	$6.23B	$77.43	$79.36	2.5%	+10.3	YES	no
C	WSBC	WesBanco, Inc.	Regional Bank NIM Re	$4.00B	$41.72	$42.50	1.9%	+21.2	YES	no
C	AUB	Atlantic Union Ba	Regional Bank NIM Re	$5.95B	$41.65	$43.19	3.7%	+9.9	YES	no
C	LGND	Ligand Pharmaceut	Biotech Royalty Stre	$6.42B	$295.70	$317.49	7.4%	+29.3	YES	no
C	INDB	Independent Bank	Regional Bank NIM Re	$3.97B	$83.82	$87.50	4.4%	+5.3	YES	no
C	FBK	FB Financial Corp	Regional Bank NIM Re	$3.04B	$60.74	$62.44	2.8%	+10.8	YES	no
C	FBNC	First Bancorp	Regional Bank NIM Re	$2.68B	$64.72	$66.54	2.8%	+6.3	YES	no

ACA

Arcosa, Inc.

$144.73

Pivot $145.98 | 0.9% away

RS vs SPY: +6.9%

A PRIME

$7.11B Cap | 48M Float

Infrastructure Products & Construction Materials | Theme: Infrastructure Spending & Reshoring | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.28

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$145.98**
% to Pivot	**0.9%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.28 Textbook**
52W Hi Prox	**98.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**633k <**
Wk2	**640k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**882k**
Coil Strength	**28.2% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+6.9%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$7.11B**
Float	**48M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**32.3**
Fwd P/E	**28.3**
Rev Growth	**1.7%**
Short %	**2.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$146.67**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $146.00 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.0M shares)

Target: $162.00 - measured move from 20-day base depth (~$8) added to pivot, representing 11% upside

Stop: $140.50 - below base low and 50-day MA support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 29 - Forward EPS $5.12 implies 14% YoY growth. TTM earnings growth of +449% reflects recovery from depressed comps and acquisition benefits. No recent guidance change detected. Last 4Q pattern shows consistent execution but watch for margin compression signals given materials cost volatility.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Arcosa manufactures infrastructure-related products across three segments: Construction Products (aggregates, specialty materials), Engineered Structures (utility structures, wind towers, storage tanks), and Transportation Products (barge components, steel components). The company is a direct beneficiary of the IIJA infrastructure buildout and domestic manufacturing reshoring trends, with diversified exposure across utilities, transportation, and energy transition.

FACTOR & THEME

Core exposure to U.S. infrastructure capex cycle (IIJA tailwinds through 2028), utility grid hardening, and reshoring-driven industrial construction. Sentiment in infrastructure theme remains constructive but has moved from early-cycle acceleration to mid-cycle steady-state; peer read-throughs (MLM, VMC, AECOM) show stable demand but margin normalization.

NEWS FLOW

No material contract wins or M&A announcements in last 60 days. Company benefits structurally from ongoing grid modernization and utility capex but lacks a discrete near-term catalyst. Russell 2000 constituent with stable index positioning. [Catalyst type: Industry/Macro; Impact: Medium]

INSTITUTIONAL

Textbook quiet accumulation signature: volume contracting 28% week-over-week while price holds within 1% of 52W high. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed. Zero insider activity in last 60 days - baseline expectation for this name. Float of 47.9M shares with avg daily volume of 690K suggests 70-day float rotation; not heavily traded but adequate liquidity for institutional positioning.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below the $142.00 base low (1.9% downside), or if Q3 earnings reveal margin compression from materials inflation exceeding 200bps. Single largest bear case: infrastructure spending delays or political uncertainty around IIJA funding extensions could pause utility/grid orders.

Textbook VCP: base_tight 1.28, strict vol dry-up confirmed (882K640K633K), price within 0.9% of pivot. Infrastructure theme offers secular tailwind but lacks imminent catalyst with earnings 80 days out. Strongest disconfirming argument: RS line not at new high (+6.9% vs SPY is modest), suggesting this is a steady compounder rather than momentum leader - may underperform in risk-on large-cap regime. Conviction: Medium.

ORKA

Oruka Therapeutics, Inc.

$105.14

Pivot $105.31 | 0.2% away

RS vs SPY: +55.2%

B BUILDING

$6.34B Cap | 50M Float

Biotechnology - Dermatology/Immunology | Theme: Next-Gen Biologics & IL-13 Pipeline | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 4.18

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$105.31**
% to Pivot	**0.2%**
Days in Base	**8**
Tightness	**4.18 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.8%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**632k <**
Wk2	**912k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**968k**
Coil Strength	**34.7% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+55.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.34B**
Float	**50M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-42.2**
Rev Growth	**-**
Short %	**22.3%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$148.17**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Hold above $105.31 post-earnings on volume confirmation >2M shares, OR gap-and-go above $108 with sustained bid

Target: $130.00 - consensus price target $148.17 suggests 40% upside; intermediate target at psychological $130 level

Stop: $95.00 - below earnings gap support and 10% risk threshold

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

August 10 - EARNINGS TODAY - pre-revenue biotech, so focus is on cash runway update, pipeline progress, and any Phase 2/3 readout timing guidance. Negative EPS expected (consensus ~-$0.60/Q). P/E inapplicable; valuation reflects pipeline optionality. Watch for insider commentary on partnership discussions or additional indication expansion.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Oruka Therapeutics is a clinical-stage biotech focused on novel biologics for chronic skin diseases, with lead programs targeting IL-13 pathways for atopic dermatitis and other inflammatory conditions. The company emerged from a 2024 restructuring/spin and has rapidly re-rated on pipeline de-risking milestones.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct exposure to biotech cycle recovery (XBI +25% YTD context from Healthcare sector leadership at +6.4% this month). IL-13/dermatology space seeing renewed M&A interest post-Sanofi/Regeneron Dupixent success. Sentiment accelerating as large pharma seeks bolt-on derm assets. Peer read-through: recent strength in HZNP, SNDX suggests risk appetite for clinical-stage names returning.

NEWS FLOW

Stock has surged from $12.84 low to $105+ (718% move) indicating major pipeline catalyst already absorbed. 22.3% short interest with 5.0 days-to-cover creates squeeze potential on any positive surprise today. No FDA PDUFA dates imminent based on clinical stage. [Catalyst type: Earnings/Corporate; Impact: High - binary event TODAY]

INSTITUTIONAL

Massive RS line breakout (+55% vs SPY) with volume dry-up into the print suggests institutions positioned ahead of catalyst. Short interest at 22.3% is extreme - any beat/raise scenario triggers mechanical covering. Zero insider buys in last 60 days, but given the magnitude of the move, insiders likely restricted. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed.

KEY RISK

BINARY EVENT RISK TODAY: Thesis invalid on any pipeline setback, funding gap disclosure, or guidance cut at this morning's print. Loose base (4.18 tightness) and only 8 days in base indicates setup is fragile - a miss could trigger 20%+ downside given elevated short interest working in reverse. Specific invalidation: close below $95.00 (prior consolidation support).

Exceptional RS (+55% vs SPY) and squeeze setup (22.3% SI, 5.0 DTC), but base_tight 4.18 is loose and EARNINGS TODAY creates pure binary risk. Healthcare sector leadership (+6.4%) provides macro tailwind. Strongest disconfirming argument: 718% run from lows means massive profit-taking risk if print disappoints; the easy money is made. Downgraded from A due to loose base and same-day binary. Conviction: Medium (event-dependent).

CLDX

Celldex Therapeutics, Inc.

$42.97

Pivot $43.21 | 0.6% away

RS vs SPY: +28.3%

B BUILDING

$3.37B Cap | 71M Float

Biotechnology - Oncology & Immunology | Theme: Antibody Therapeutics & Oncology Pipeline | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.03

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$43.21**
% to Pivot	**0.6%**
Days in Base	**5**
Tightness	**5.03 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.4%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**824k <**
Wk2	**1078k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**972k**
Coil Strength	**15.2% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+28.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.37B**
Float	**71M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-10.3**
Rev Growth	**-97.0%**
Short %	**11.6%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$58.07**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $43.25 on volume >1.5M shares (>150% of 1.02M avg)

Target: $58.00 - Street consensus target at $58.07 represents 35% upside
Stop: $40.00 - below base low and round number support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Reported August 6 (4 days ago) - print is digested. Pre-revenue biotech; P/E inapplicable. Focus shifts to upcoming clinical milestones and potential partnership/licensing news. Cash position update from recent print should confirm runway through key data readouts.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Celldex develops antibody-based therapeutics targeting cancer and inflammatory diseases. Lead asset barzolvolimab (anti-KIT) is in Phase 2/3 for chronic spontaneous urticaria (CSU) and other mast cell-driven diseases. Recent positive data readouts have driven the stock's re-rating cycle.

FACTOR & THEME

Pure biotech cycle exposure with Healthcare leading sectors (+6.4%). CSU market is validated (Xolair precedent), and barzolvolimab differentiation on efficacy/durability drives M&A speculation. Peer read-through: ALNY, IONS strength confirms market appetite for differentiated biologics platforms.

NEWS FLOW

Post-earnings consolidation with RS line at new high indicates positive reception to Q2 update. Watch for barzolvolimab Phase 3 enrollment updates or FDA meeting disclosures in coming weeks. No PDUFA dates imminent. Elevated short interest (11.6%, 5.8 DTC) provides squeeze fuel on positive pipeline news. [Catalyst type: Corporate/Clinical; Impact: Medium - data-driven]

INSTITUTIONAL

RS line at 52W high with stock 0.6% from pivot post-earnings suggests strong hands accumulated into and through the print. Volume dry-up (-15% week-over-week) confirms digestion rather than distribution. Zero insider buying in 60 days - typical for clinical-stage biotech in blackout. Institutional ownership data unavailable.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $40.00 (base low and psychological support), or on any barzolvolimab clinical hold or competitive data from peers in CSU space. Primary bear case: 5.03 base_tight is loose for A-grade consideration; only 5 days in base means pattern is immature and could easily fail on sector rotation.

RS line at new high (+28% vs SPY) with post-earnings consolidation is constructive. Healthcare sector tailwind and validated target biology support fundamental case. However, base_tight 5.03 is loose, only 5 days in base, and vol_dryup_strict is false - pattern needs more time. Strongest disconfirming argument: clinical-stage biotech with binary pipeline risk; next catalyst timing unclear. Conviction: Medium.

ADPT

Adaptive Biotechnologies Corporation

$25.45

Pivot $26.16 | 2.8% away

RS vs SPY: +83.1%

B BUILDING

$4.05B Cap | 124M Float

Diagnostics & Immune Sequencing | Theme: Precision Diagnostics & MRD Testing | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.0

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$26.16**
% to Pivot	**2.8%**
Days in Base	**8**
Tightness	**3.00 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.3%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**2607k <**
Wk2	**3139k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**2758k**
Coil Strength	**5.5% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+83.1%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.05B**
Float	**124M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-137.8**
Rev Growth	**21.5%**
Short %	**9.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$25.07**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $26.20 on volume >4.5M shares (>150% of 2.88M avg)

Target: $32.00 - 25% upside based on measured move from $21-$26 base range
Stop: $23.50 - below post-earnings consolidation low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Reported July 29 (12 days ago) - Q2 print digested. Revenue growing +21.5% YoY shows commercial traction. Still unprofitable (EPS -$0.40 TTM improving to -$0.18 fwd), but path to profitability visible with operating leverage. Recent beat drove the post-earnings rally now consolidating near highs.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Adaptive Biotechnologies is a commercial-stage diagnostics company specializing in immune system sequencing. Its clonoSEQ platform for minimal residual disease (MRD) testing in blood cancers is FDA-cleared and reimbursed by CMS, while its immune medicine partnership with Genentech targets T-cell receptor therapeutics. The company sits at the intersection of precision oncology diagnostics and next-gen immunotherapy development.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposure to precision diagnostics secular growth and oncology MRD testing adoption curve. Healthcare sector leadership (+6.4%) provides favorable backdrop. Peer read-through: EXAS, GH strength in liquid biopsy/MRD space confirms theme momentum. Genentech partnership provides optionality on TCR therapeutic development without binary trial risk.

NEWS FLOW

Post-earnings base formation with RS line at 52W high (+83% vs SPY is exceptional). clonoSEQ Medicare coverage expansion or additional cancer indication clearances would be catalysts. Genentech collaboration milestones provide upside optionality. No near-term FDA dates but watch for ASCO/ASH conference presentations. [Catalyst type: Corporate; Impact: Medium]

INSTITUTIONAL

Exceptional relative strength (+83% vs SPY) with RS line at new high indicates aggressive institutional accumulation. Post-earnings consolidation with mild volume dry-up (5.5% contraction - weakest of candidates) suggests absorption rather than distribution, though dry-up is minimal. Beta of 2.09 means amplified moves in either direction. Zero insider activity in 60 days. Institutional ownership data unavailable.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $23.50 (post-earnings gap support), or on Genentech partnership modification/termination, or CMS reimbursement rate cuts for MRD testing. Primary bear case: high debt/equity (272%) and continued cash burn creates dilution risk if profitability timeline slips; any secondary offering would pressure shares significantly.

Best RS of all candidates (+83% vs SPY) with Healthcare tailwind and commercial revenue growth visible. However, vol_dryup_strict is false (only 5.5% contraction), base_tight 3.0 is moderate, and 8 days in base is early. Strongest disconfirming argument: debt/equity of 272% and cash burn mean dilution risk is real if growth slows - this is not a clean balance sheet story. Conviction: Medium.

AXGN

AxoGen, Inc.

$48.22

Pivot $48.72 | 1.0% away

RS vs SPY: +13.4%

B BUILDING

$2.59B Cap | 52M Float

Regenerative Medicine - Nerve Repair | Theme: Surgical Nerve Repair & Regenerative MedTech | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 4.23

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$48.72**
% to Pivot	**1.0%**
Days in Base	**6**
Tightness	**4.23 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.1%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**867k <**
Wk2	**1579k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1063k**
Coil Strength	**18.4% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+13.4%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$2.59B**
Float	**52M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**69.7**
Rev Growth	**23.1%**
Short %	**11.7%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$53.22**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $48.75 on volume >2.0M shares (>160% of 1.24M avg)

Target: $58.00 - Street target $53.22 plus momentum premium for squeeze scenario
Stop: $45.00 - below base low and psychological support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 28 - Forward EPS $0.69 implies path to profitability after years of losses (TTM EPS -$0.67). Revenue growth +23.1% demonstrates surgical adoption acceleration. Approaching profitability inflection could drive multiple expansion. Earnings 79 days out - no near-term print catalyst.

BUSINESS & POSITION

AxoGen is the leading company in peripheral nerve repair, offering processed nerve allografts (Avance), nerve connectors, and nerve cuffs used in trauma, breast reconstruction, and other surgical settings. The company has near-monopoly positioning in the surgical nerve repair niche with 74.6% gross margins and accelerating revenue (+23% YoY).

FACTOR & THEME

Niche MedTech exposure with category-leader positioning in underserved surgical market. Healthcare sector leadership (+6.4%) supports setup. Peer read-through: strength in specialty surgical names (ISRG, GMED) confirms appetite for differentiated MedTech. Elective procedure recovery post-COVID fully realized; growth now structural.

NEWS FLOW

RS line at new high with stock within 1% of pivot post-recent strength. No discrete corporate catalysts in last 60 days but surgical adoption trajectory is self-reinforcing. Elevated short interest (11.7%, 3.3 DTC) provides squeeze potential on continued execution. Watch for ASC (ambulatory surgery center) penetration data or new product launches. [Catalyst type: Corporate; Impact: Medium]

INSTITUTIONAL

RS line at 52W high suggests accumulation despite elevated short interest. Volume dry-up (18.4% contraction) with price holding indicates quiet institutional absorption. Zero insider activity in 60 days - note absence given approaching profitability inflection where insider buys would be high-conviction signal. Institutional ownership data unavailable.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $45.00 (base low support), or on competitive entry announcement from major MedTech player (JNJ, MDT) into nerve repair space, or on surgical procedure volume slowdown. Primary bear case: base_tight 4.23 is loose and forward P/E of 70x prices in significant growth - any execution miss punishes valuation.

Category leader with RS line at new high, 23% revenue growth, and approaching profitability inflection. Healthcare tailwind supports. However, base_tight 4.23 is loose, only 6 days in base, vol_dryup_strict false, and no near-term catalyst with earnings 79 days away. Strongest disconfirming argument: 70x forward P/E assumes flawless execution - any miss triggers significant de-rating. Conviction: Medium.

HWC

Hancock Whitney Corporation

$77.43

Pivot $79.36 | 2.5% away

RS vs SPY: +10.3%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.23B Cap | 79M Float

Regional Banking - Gulf Coast Focus | Theme: Regional Bank NIM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.22

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$79.36**
% to Pivot	**2.5%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.22 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.6%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**705k <**
Wk2	**876k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1056k**
Coil Strength	**33.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+10.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.23B**
Float	**79M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**15.2**
Fwd P/E	**10.6**
Rev Growth	**7.6%**
Short %	**10.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$83.80**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $79.40 on volume >1.5M shares

Target: $86.00 - Street target $83.80 plus momentum premium

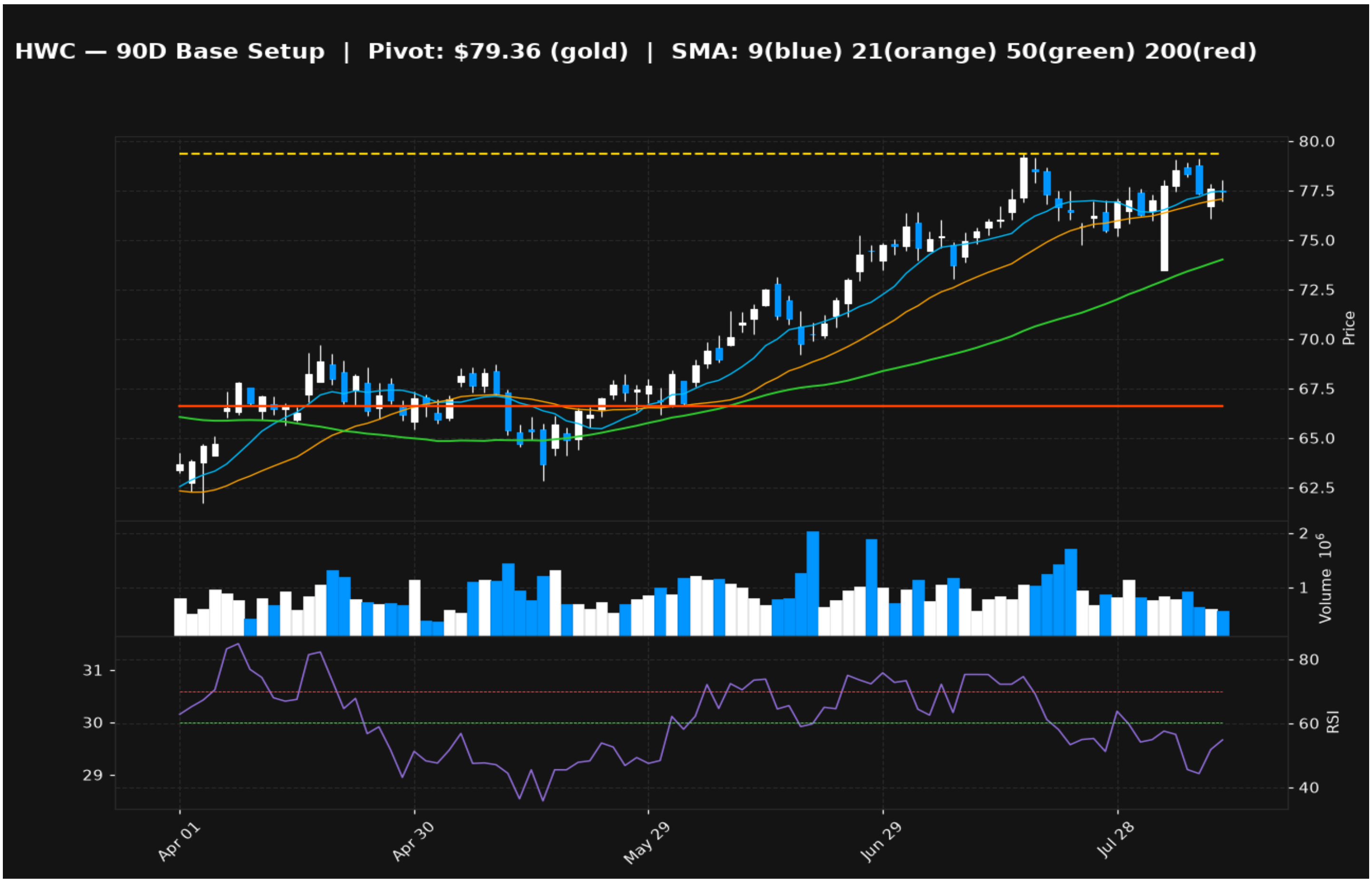
Stop: $74.50 - below 50-day MA and base low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 13

Regional bank with solid vol dry-up (33% contraction) and reasonable base_tight (2.22), but RS line not at new high and sector not in leadership. No near-term catalyst with earnings 64 days out. Financial Services not a leading sector currently. Monitor for rate-cut catalyst or sector rotation. Conviction: Low.



WSBC

WesBanco, Inc.

$41.72

Pivot $42.50 | 1.9% away

RS vs SPY: +21.2%

C EARLY STAGE

$4.00B Cap | 92M Float

Regional Banking - Mid-Atlantic/Ohio Valley | Theme: Regional Bank NIM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.72

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$42.50**
% to Pivot	**1.9%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.72 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.2%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**751k <**
Wk2	**779k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1226k**
Coil Strength	**38.8% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+21.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.00B**
Float	**92M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**11.9**
Fwd P/E	**10.8**
Rev Growth	**3.5%**
Short %	**7.3%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$44.25**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $42.55 on volume >2.0M shares

Target: $47.00 - Street target $44.25 plus measured move
Stop: $39.50 - below base low support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 21

Decent RS (+21% vs SPY) but base_tight 3.72 is loose and RS line not at new high. Regional bank sector lacks current leadership. Earnings catalyst 72 days away provides no near-term trigger. Watch for base tightening over next 2-3 weeks before promoting. Conviction: Low.

AUB

Atlantic Union Bankshares Corporation

$41.65

Pivot $43.19 | 3.7% away

RS vs SPY: +9.9%

C EARLY STAGE

$5.95B Cap | 141M Float

Regional Banking - Mid-Atlantic | Theme: Regional Bank NIM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.81

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$43.19**
% to Pivot	**3.7%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.81 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**95.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**783k <**
Wk2	**854k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1372k**
Coil Strength	**42.9% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+9.9%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$5.95B**
Float	**141M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**12.1**
Fwd P/E	**10.3**
Rev Growth	**35.8%**
Short %	**7.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$47.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $43.25 on volume >1.8M shares

Target: $48.00 - Street target $47.00 plus measured move

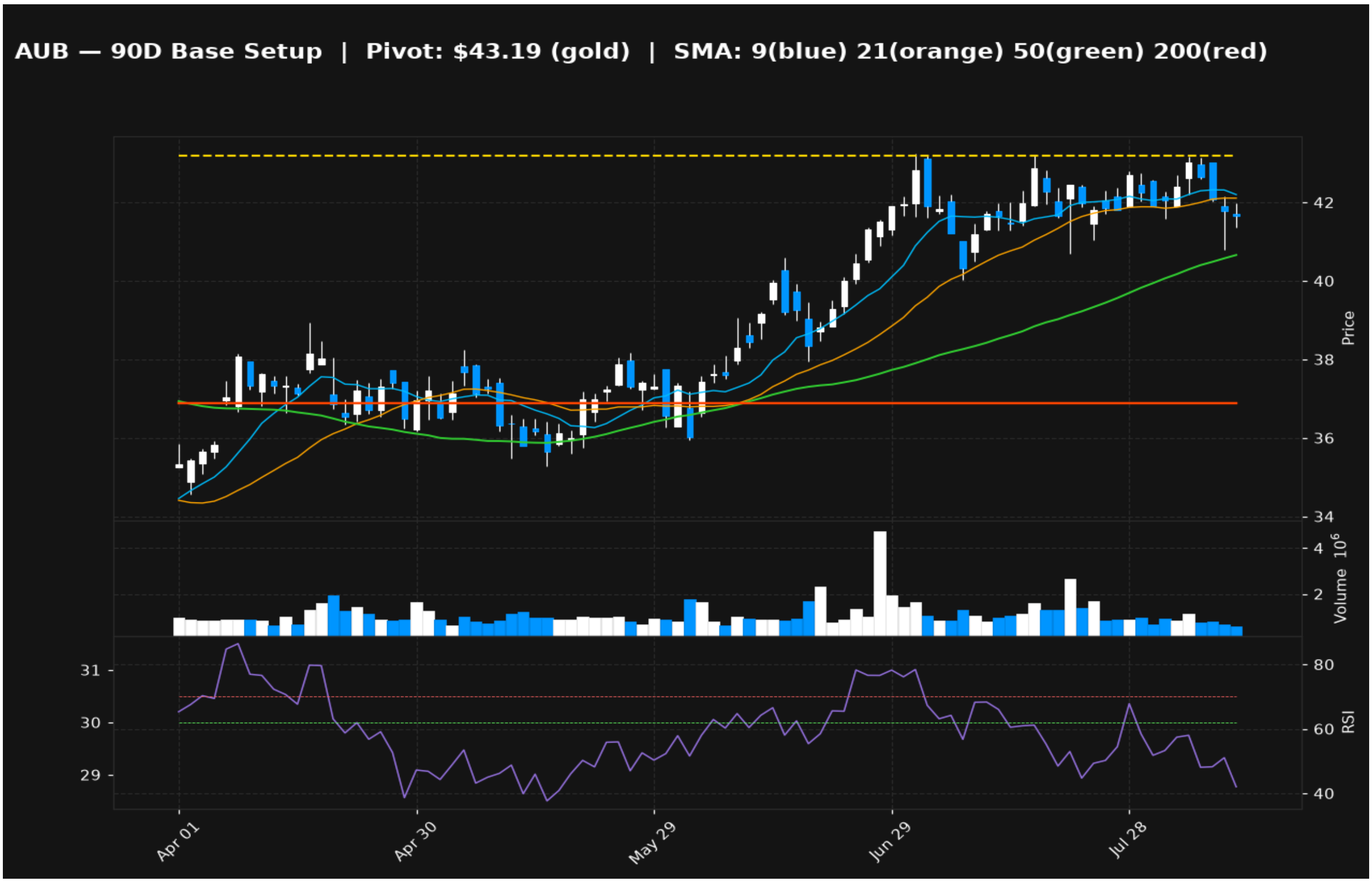
Stop: $40.00 - below base low and round number

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 22

Tightest base of regional bank cohort (1.81) with strong vol contraction (43%), but RS line not at new high and 3.7% from pivot is wider than leaders. Financial Services not in sector leadership. Earnings 73 days out provides no near-term catalyst. Monitor for sector rotation. Conviction: Low.



LGND

Ligand Pharmaceuticals Incorporated

$295.70

Pivot $317.49 | 7.4% away

RS vs SPY: +29.3%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.42B Cap | 20M Float

Biotechnology - Royalty & Platform Model | Theme: Biotech Royalty Streams & Platform Licensing | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.53

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$317.49**
% to Pivot	**7.4%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.53 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**90.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**285k <**
Wk2	**292k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**324k**
Coil Strength	**12.0% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+29.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.42B**
Float	**20M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**30.5**
Fwd P/E	**24.7**
Rev Growth	**33.7%**
Short %	**11.5%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$343.80**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $317.50 on volume >550K shares

Target: $365.00 - Street target $343.80 plus momentum
Stop: $280.00 - below 50-day MA and prior consolidation

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 5

Excellent base quality (tight 1.53, strict vol dry-up), but 7.4% from pivot is too far for actionable entry. RS line not at new high despite +29% vs SPY. Profitable biotech royalty model is defensive but lacks near-term catalyst with earnings 87 days out. Add to watchlist; promote if base tightens with RS line breakout. Conviction: Low.

INDB

Independent Bank Corp.

$83.82

Pivot $87.50 | 4.4% away

RS vs SPY: +5.3%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.97B Cap | 47M Float

Regional Banking - New England | Theme: Regional Bank NIM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.92

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$87.50**
% to Pivot	**4.4%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.92 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**95.8%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**287k <**
Wk2	**424k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**455k**
Coil Strength	**37.0% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+5.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.97B**
Float	**47M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**15.2**
Fwd P/E	**10.1**
Rev Growth	**41.5%**
Short %	**5.6%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$92.71**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $87.55 on volume >600K shares

Target: $95.00 - Street target $92.71 plus measured move

Stop: $80.00 - below base low and 50-day MA

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 22

Good base structure (1.92 tightness, 37% vol contraction), but 4.4% from pivot is wide and RS only +5% vs SPY shows underperformance. Regional bank with no sector leadership tailwind. Earnings 73 days out. Watch only. Conviction: Low.

INDB — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: $87.50 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)

FBK

FB Financial Corporation

$60.74

Pivot $62.44 | 2.8% away

RS vs SPY: +10.8%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.04B Cap | 49M Float

Regional Banking - Southeast | Theme: Regional Bank NIM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.11

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$62.44**
% to Pivot	**2.8%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.11 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.3%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**297k <**
Wk2	**410k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**456k**
Coil Strength	**34.8% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+10.8%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.04B**
Float	**49M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**16.1**
Fwd P/E	**11.8**
Rev Growth	**130.2%**
Short %	**6.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$66.09**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $62.50 on volume >600K shares

Target: $70.00 - Street target $66.09 plus momentum premium

Stop: $58.00 - below base low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 13

Strong vol dry-up (35% contraction, 0.34x today's ratio) but loose base (3.11), RS line not at high, and no sector tailwind. 130% revenue growth is eye-catching but reflects M&A rather than organic - normalize expectations. Earnings 64 days out. Monitor for base tightening. Conviction: Low.

FBNC

First Bancorp

$64.72

Pivot $66.54 | 2.8% away

RS vs SPY: +6.3%

C EARLY STAGE

$2.68B Cap | 41M Float

Regional Banking - Carolinas | Theme: Regional Bank NIM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.47

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$66.54**
% to Pivot	**2.8%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.47 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.3%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**180k <**
Wk2	**196k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**328k**
Coil Strength	**44.9% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+6.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$2.68B**
Float	**41M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**20.1**
Fwd P/E	**12.8**
Rev Growth	**15.9%**
Short %	**6.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$69.40**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $66.60 on volume >400K shares

Target: $73.00 - Street target $69.40 plus measured move
Stop: $62.00 - below base low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 21

Best vol contraction of regional bank cohort (45%) but RS +6.3% is weakest in the group. Modest base tightness (2.47), RS line not at high. Financial Services lacking sector leadership. Earnings 72 days away. Pure monitoring status. Conviction: Low.